

Title

A Two-Year Prospective Evaluation of Web-Delivered Therapeutic Intervention for Anxiety Disorders in Preadolescents: Study Design and Methodological Framework

Abstract

Anxiety disorders remain highly prevalent in school-age populations, yet access to specialized mental health services remains limited. This protocol describes a prospective randomized trial comparing technology-assisted therapeutic intervention against digital informational control in Finnish preadolescents screened for anxiety. We will enroll approximately 465 children aged 10-13 years identified through population-based screening. The intervention arm will receive structured web-based modules (10 sessions) combined with periodic remote clinical support. The control arm will receive standard psychoeducational digital materials. Participants will be assessed at baseline, 12 months, and 24 months post-randomization using validated caregiver and youth self-report scales. Primary analyses will employ linear mixed-effects regression to compare anxiety symptom trajectories between arms. Secondary analyses will examine moderators including baseline severity, gender, and treatment engagement. We will also assess functional impairment, mood symptoms, and parental psychological adjustment. This design allows for evaluation of both immediate and sustained effects of the intervention.